MARCH 2026

APPENDIX

IDEA9105 A1 ASSIGNMENT
INTERFACE DESIGN

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IDEA 9105

A1 BACKGROUND RESEARCH

A2 ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

A3 USER PERSONAS

A4 JOBS-TO-BE-DONE FRAMEWORK

A5 AI ACKNOWLEDGMENT

A 1

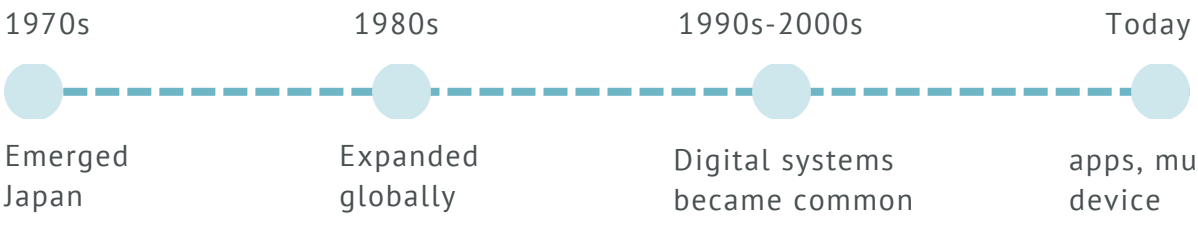
BACKGROUND RESEARCH

What Is Karaoke?

Karaoke is a form of entertainment in which people sing along to instrumental versions of songs while lyrics are displayed on a screen. However, karaoke is more than a music activity. It is also a participatory social experience because it involves performance, audience attention, turn-taking, and shared interaction in group settings. In the context of this project, karaoke is especially relevant because it often takes place in public or semi-public environments such as bars, karaoke rooms, parties, and organised social events, where users may experience confidence, embarrassment, self-presentation, and group participation at the same time (Encyclopaedia Britannica, 2026).

Origin and History of Karaoke

Karaoke originated in Japan and is generally traced to the early 1970s. According to Encyclopaedia Britannica, karaoke first appeared in Kōbe, Japan, where it became popular among businessmen in the late 1970s, before spreading internationally and becoming widely popular in the United States in the late 1980s (Encyclopaedia Britannica, 2026). Daisuke Inoue is widely associated with the early development of karaoke. The World Intellectual Property Organization explain that Inoue began renting out early karaoke machines with tape-recorded music in 1971, and that later technological developments, such as laser-disc systems in the 1980s, contributed to the expansion and sophistication of karaoke formats (Swaminathan, 2009). Over time, karaoke evolved from simple sing-along devices into broader digital entertainment systems with lyric displays, searchable song libraries, and room-based or venue-based interaction, showing that karaoke has always been shaped by both technology and social behaviour (Encyclopaedia Britannica, 2026; Swaminathan, 2009).



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BACKGROUND RESEARCH

Karaoke as a Social and Cultural Practice

Karaoke is widely understood as more than entertainment; it is also a social and cultural practice. Research in game and play studies describes karaoke as a form of social performance play that is easily adapted into different communities and settings, highlighting its role in participation, shared experience, and performative interaction (Bryan & Tanenbaum, 2019). At the same time, karaoke is emotionally complex. A clinical study on karaoke therapy found evidence of improved social interaction in some participants, while also indicating that karaoke could be linked to anxiety in certain situations, which is especially relevant in public or semi-public contexts where users may feel judged or exposed (Leung et al., 1998). This tention between enjoyment and vulnerability makes karaoke a valuable design context for exploring how interfaces and environments can better support comfort, inclusion, and engagement (Bryan & Tanenbaum, 2019; Leung et al., 1998).

Positive Experiences
- fun
- bonding
- self-expression
- participation

Challenges
- anxiety
- embarrassment
- judgement
- pressure to perform

performance • participation • audience • confidence • vulnerability • interaction

A 1

BACKGROUND RESEARCH

The Contemporary Karaoke Scene

Contemporary karaoke is no longer confined to a single, standardised venue, but is now found across a wide variety of settings. In Japan, karaoke has evolved from a singing culture centred on bars into a broader service system, encompassing karaoke booths, bars, and other commercial venues such as hotels, coaches and restaurants. With the rise of the private karaoke booth model, a significant shift has taken place: private booths have made singing the primary purpose of a visit, rather than a secondary activity to drinking. This has also broadened participation, allowing users to interact in smaller, more intimate social settings. Consequently, contemporary karaoke can be understood not merely as a musical activity, but as a place-based social service shaped by space, privacy, technology and group interaction (Green, 2022).

Current Challenges in the Karaoke Experience

The challenges facing karaoke stem not only from technical or environmental factors, but are also influenced by social and emotional factors. Research on performance anxiety suggests that people often feel anxious when performing, stemming from a fear of judgment, the pressure to meet others' expectations, and the awareness that they are being watched. These dynamics are closely linked to karaoke, as participants typically perform in front of peers or an audience. Social support is also a key factor, as users who feel a lack of support are more prone to anxiety and may avoid participation. This suggests that the challenges in karaoke are deeply linked to social dynamics, emotional responses and group interactions, rather than being merely functional issues (Huawei et al., 2024).

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BACKGROUND RESEARCH

Karaoke and Digital Technology

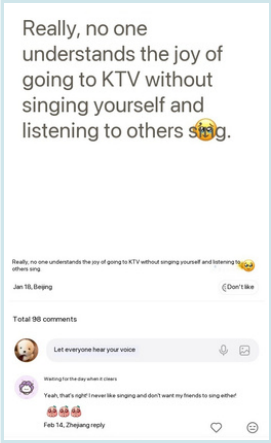
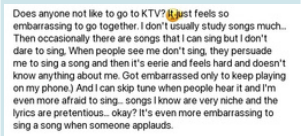
Contemporary karaoke increasingly depends on digital and connected interfaces rather than a single standalone machine. Mobile social karaoke systems can support group creation, song sharing, real-time messaging, and flexible participation through smartphones and cloud-based services, showing that karaoke technology shapes not only functional tasks but also social interaction and coordination (Shin, 2023). This creates clear opportunities for interface design to improve accessibility, emotional comfort, and inclusive participation across devices.

Why Karaoke is a Design Opportunity

Karaoke can be considered a strong design opportunity because it shares characteristics with broader music performance contexts, where emotional, social, and cognitive challenges shape user experience. Research shows that music performance anxiety is a complex and multi-factorial phenomenon influenced by fear of negative evaluation, social pressure, and individual psychological traits (Dobos et al., 2018). These factors highlight that musical participation is not only a technical activity, but also a socially situated and emotionally demanding experience. In karaoke settings, these dynamics are amplified by public or semi-public environments, making it a valuable context for design innovation. This suggests that karaoke offers significant opportunities for interface design to better support emotional comfort, participation, and social interaction.

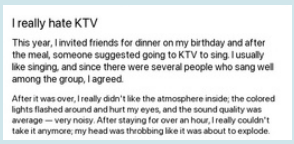
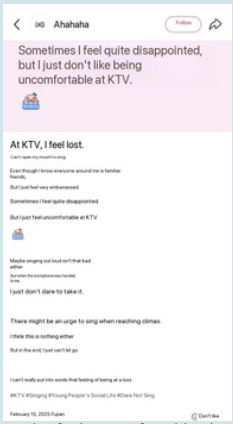
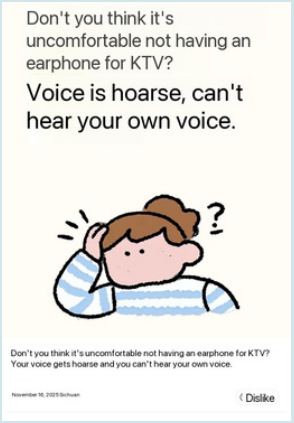
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Red note • Date: 12/02/2026 • Topic: A user discusses preferring bright lighting in KTV instead of dark blue ambient lights • Relevant research area: environmental comfort, lighting preference, karaoke atmosphere		• The user dislikes the typical dim and coloured KTV lighting • She prefers bright lighting because it feels more comfortable • The post suggests she sometimes goes to KTV alone • Her tone is hesitant and seeking validation, as she asks whether this preference seems strange	• Lighting strongly affects comfort and sense of control in karaoke spaces • Some users may feel safer or more relaxed in brighter environments • KTV settings are not one-size-fits-all; users may want more environmental control • This suggests a design opportunity for custom lighting modes	Environmental comfort / lighting preference
• Platform: Red note • Date: Post dated 01-18, Beijing; comment dated 02-14, Zhejiang • Topic: A user says they enjoy going to KTV, but do not necessarily want to sing themselves • Relevant research area: alternative participation, listener roles, social participation in karaoke		• The user enjoys listening to other people sing rather than performing • Their attitude is slightly emotional and seeks understanding • This indicates that some people participate socially in karaoke without wanting to sing • The post frames KTV as a social event, but not all participation is performance-based	• Not all karaoke users want to perform; some prefer a listener role • Current expectations around karaoke may assume everyone should sing, which excludes some users • Design could better support non-singing participation • Participation in karaoke should be understood as broader than just performing	Alternative participation / listener-type users
• Platform: Red note • Date: 05/10/2025 • Topic: A user explains why they do not enjoy going to KTV • Relevant research area: performance anxiety, embarrassment, confidence, song familiarity	 Users who feel embarrassed and avoid singing in KTV	• The user says they do not really like going to KTV • Reasons include not knowing many songs, being afraid to sing, worrying about singing off-key, and feeling awkward when others ask them to sing • Their tone is self-conscious, anxious, and withdrawn • The user avoids participation by staying on their phone • This post reflects a strong sense of social pressure and fear of judgment	• For some users, KTV is a stressful rather than enjoyable social space • Lack of song familiarity and fear of judgment are major barriers to participation • Avoidant behaviours like using a phone may indicate discomfort and disengagement	Performance anxiety / embarrassment and low confidence

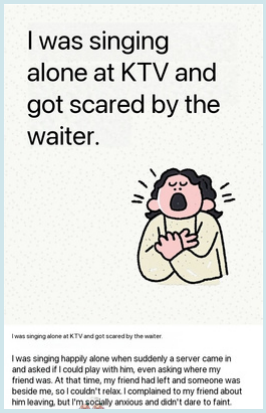
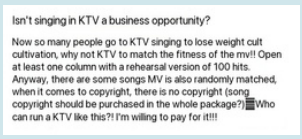
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Red note • Date: 02/02/2025 • Topic: A user explains why they do not enjoy going to KTV • Relevant research area: performance anxiety, embarrassment, confidence, song familiarity	 I really hate KTV This year, I invited friends for dinner on my birthday and after the meal, someone suggested going to KTV to sing. I usually like singing, and since there were several people who sang well among the group, I agreed. After it was over, I really didn't like the atmosphere inside; the colored lights flashed around and hurt my eyes, and the sound quality was average — very noisy. After staying for over an hour, I really couldn't take it anymore; my head was throbbing like it was about to explode. Users who strongly dislike the KTV environment	• The user attended KTV after a birthday dinner, so they were not the one initiating the KTV visit • Although they like singing, they still dislike the KTV environment • Complaints include flashing coloured lights, poor sound quality, loudness, and headaches • Their attitude is intense, frustrated, and physically uncomfortable	• KTV environments may be overstimulating for some users • Sensory factors such as lighting, noise, and sound quality can reduce enjoyment • Karaoke design should consider users who are sensitive to overstimulating spaces • The entertainment environment itself may be a bigger barrier than singing	dislike of karaoke environment
• Platform: Red note • Date: 2025-02-15, Fujian • Topic: A user feels awkward and "kills the mood" because they cannot bring themselves to sing in KTV • Relevant research area: social discomfort, performance pressure, and anxiety among familiar groups	 Ahahaha Sometimes I feel quite disappointed, but I just don't like being uncomfortable at KTV. At KTV, I feel lost. I just don't dare to take it. Users who feel uncomfortable singing even with close friends	• The user says they are with familiar friends, but still cannot comfortably sing • They feel guilty and describe themselves as "boring" or "spoiling the fun" • They describe wanting to join in, but freezing when attention shifts to them	• Familiarity with the group does not automatically remove performance anxiety • Some users fear not only singing badly, but also disrupting the social atmosphere • Participation pressure in group karaoke can create emotional conflict	Social discomfort/fear of singing among friends
• Platform: Red note • Date: 2025-11-16, Sichuan • Topic: A user complains that KTV is hard to use because there is no in-ear monitoring or clear vocal feedback • Relevant research area: audio feedback, singing support, vocal control, sound experience	 Don't you think it's uncomfortable not having an earphone for KTV? Voice is hoarse, can't hear your own voice. Don't you think it's uncomfortable not having an earphone for KTV? Your voice gets hoarse and you can't hear your own voice. Dislike	• The user is frustrated that they cannot clearly hear their own voice • They say this causes physical strain, such as shouting until their throat hurts • The complaint suggests some users care deeply about performance support, not just entertainment	• Poor vocal feedback reduces confidence, comfort, and vocal control • Audio design affects both performance quality and physical comfort • Users may overcompensate by singing louder, which increases fatigue • This suggests a design opportunity around better feedback, monitoring, or personalised sound settings	Audio feedback / lack of singing support

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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Red note • Date: 26/07/2025 • Topic: A user was singing alone in KTV and was startled when a staff member suddenly entered and spoke to them • Relevant research area: solo karaoke, privacy, interruption, interpersonal boundaries, social anxiety		• The user was using KTV alone • They were frightened and became socially uncomfortable when a staff member entered unexpectedly • Their attitude is anxious, startled, and socially withdrawn • They say they cannot relax when someone is physically near them • This post likely resonates with other users who value privacy and low interruption	• For solo users, the KTV room may function as a private and controlled personal space • Unexpected staff interaction can break that sense of safety and comfort • Interruption is not just inconvenient; it may trigger social anxiety and self-consciousness • Design could better support privacy through do-not-disturb options or clearer service protocols	Solo karaoke / privacy and interruption
• Platform: Reddit • Date: 6 months ago • Topic: A user suggests improving karaoke song search by pulling from more YouTube karaoke sources • Relevant research area: song search, platform usability, content access, karaoke discovery	 Users expect karaoke systems to provide more accurate and flexible search functions to easily access desired songs across platforms	• The user is frustrated with limited search results and wants broader access to karaoke content. • The user is already familiar with how karaoke content is labelled online and suggests adding "karaoke" automatically to searches. • The user also recommends a specific karaoke channel, showing that people actively develop workarounds or source preferences. • Socially, this is a form of participatory problem-solving: the user is not only complaining, but proposing a design improvement.	• Users want karaoke systems to make song search easier and more intelligent. • Search friction is a meaningful barrier in digital karaoke experiences. • Karaoke discovery is shaped by how platforms label, filter, and surface content. • This suggests an opportunity for better query support, automatic filtering, and smarter karaoke-specific search interfaces.	Digital usability / karaoke search and content discovery
• Platform: Red Note • Date: 11/09/2025 • Topic: A user discusses the possibility of combining KTV singing with fitness or exercise-related content • Relevant research area: alternative karaoke experiences, physical engagement, health-related motivation	 Users are interested in karaoke experiences that combine singing with physical activity, seeing it as a way to support fitness or health-related goals.	• The user suggests that singing in KTV could be linked to weight loss and fitness, proposing the idea of matching songs with exercise-style MV content. • The user expresses willingness to pay, indicating perceived value in this type of experience. • The post includes hashtags related to fitness, exercise, and weight loss, showing a crossover between entertainment and health communities.	• Some users perceive karaoke not only as entertainment, but as a potentially active and physically engaging experience. • Singing is associated with bodily activity (e.g. movement, breathing, energy), which users link to fitness outcomes. • It suggests a design opportunity to rethink karaoke interfaces to support movement, guidance, or fitness-oriented interaction.	Karaoke as a physically engaging and health-related activity

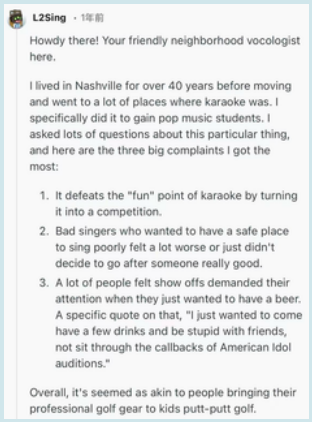
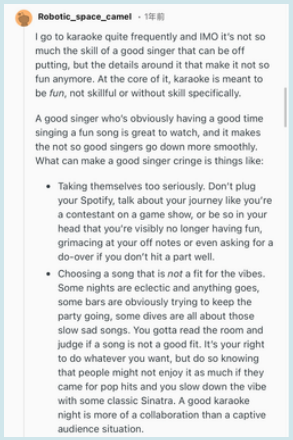
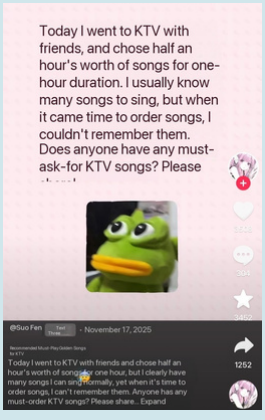
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Reddit • Date: 8 months ago • Topic: Users discuss whether karaoke is easy to avoid and how its presence differs by country • Relevant research area: cultural context, venue culture, environmental fit, annoyance vs enjoyment	 Users experience karaoke differently depending on social context, with enjoyment or frustration shaped by environment and situation.	• A comment adds a detailed account of being annoyed by karaoke in a bar because of noise, drunk singers, and the inability to talk during a date. • Interestingly, the same user still says they like karaoke in general and wish it were more common, which shows a mixed attitude. • It also shows that karaoke may be welcomed or rejected depending on the social situation, not just the activity itself.	• Karaoke is experienced differently across countries and venue cultures. • Users may enjoy karaoke in some contexts but dislike it in others, especially when it clashes with the intended social atmosphere. • Context matters: a karaoke night in a noisy bar may create irritation even for people who like karaoke elsewhere.	Context dependence / cultural and situational variation in karaoke experience
• Platform: Red Note • Date: March 8, 2024, Shandong • Topic: A user describes overcoming KTV fear through support from a close partner • Relevant research area: confidence-building, emotional support, participation anxiety, social encouragement		• The user explicitly describes having "KTV phobia" in the past. • The post links confidence-building to emotional support from another person. • The user normalises issues such as pitch problems and low singing confidence. • This post frames karaoke confidence as socially developed, not purely individual. • Socially, the comment directly offers encouragement to another user, showing peer-to-peer emotional support.	• Confidence in karaoke can be shaped by supportive relationships. • Users may participate more when they feel safe, encouraged, and not judged. • This suggests that karaoke anxiety is not fixed, but can be reduced through social reassurance. • Design could support more collaborative, low-pressure, or confidence-building participation modes.	Emotional support / confidence-building in karaoke participation
• Platform: Red Note • Date: not clearly visible in the screenshot • Topic: A user is confused by how different their voice sounds in KTV compared with singing at home • Relevant research area: sound feedback, self-perception, audio conditions, vocal control		• The user feels their voice changes in KTV and says they cannot clearly hear themselves. • The user compares singing in KTV with singing at home, suggesting that context changes vocal perception. • The post shows that users monitor their own performance and may become distressed when the environment distorts feedback. • The user later recorded themselves and felt shocked, showing strong concern about vocal identity and control.	• Audio feedback in KTV can strongly affect how users perceive their own voices. • When users cannot hear themselves clearly, they may lose confidence and feel confused about their performance. • Karaoke is not only a social experience, but also an acoustic and sensory one. • This suggests design opportunities around clearer vocal feedback, monitoring, and audio reassurance.	Audio feedback / self-perception and vocal control

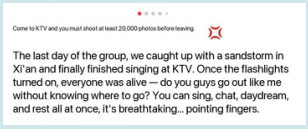
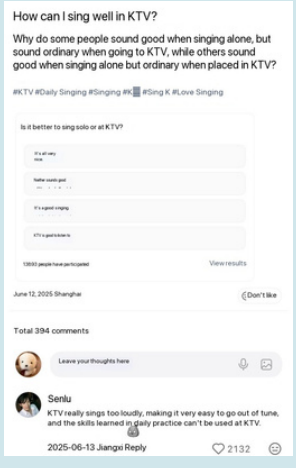
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Reddit • Date: 1 year ago • Topic: A self-identified vocologist summarises common complaints about karaoke becoming too competitive • Relevant research area: social atmosphere, competition, safety, casual participation		• The commenter positions themselves as knowledgeable and experienced. • They say karaoke stops being fun when it becomes competitive. • They note that weaker singers feel worse after a strong singer performs, and some users want karaoke to remain a "safe place to sing poorly." • The user frames karaoke as casual leisure, not professional performance.	• Many users value karaoke as a low-stakes and playful environment rather than a showcase of skill. • Competition and comparison can damage inclusiveness and discourage participation. • Karaoke enjoyment depends partly on preserving a safe, non-judgmental atmosphere. • This suggests that design should protect playful participation and avoid reinforcing performance hierarchies.	Social pressure / competition versus safe participation
• Platform: Reddit • Date: 1 year ago • Topic: A frequent karaoke user explains that what makes good singers "cringe" is not skill itself, but behaviour and failure to match the room's vibe • Relevant research area: group dynamics, room-reading, social fit, collaborative participation		• The user distinguishes between a skilled singer having fun and a singer taking themselves too seriously. • They emphasise that karaoke should be "fun, not skilful." • The comment highlights two problems: attention-seeking behaviour and choosing songs that do not fit the room's mood. • Socially, the comment suggests an implicit etiquette: good karaoke depends on reading the room and respecting shared atmosphere.	• Karaoke is shaped by collective mood and unspoken social rules. • A successful karaoke performance is socially appropriate, not just technically strong. • Users expect collaboration, not domination, from participants. • This suggests karaoke systems or experiences could better support awareness of group vibe, collaboration, and balanced participation.	Group dynamics / karaoke as collaborative social interaction
• Platform: Douyin • Date: November 17, 2025 • Topic: Difficulty choosing songs during karaoke • Area: song selection/memory/ decision-making		• The user says they know many songs but cannot recall them when ordering. • The tone is slightly frustrated but also seeking help. • The user directly asks others for recommendations → shows active social interaction. • High engagement (likes/comments) suggests this is a common issue. • Indicates users rely on memory rather than system support.	• Users may experience cognitive overload when selecting songs in time-limited settings. • Karaoke systems may not support memory recall or suggestion effectively. • Suggests an opportunity for recommendation systems or pre-selection tools.	Song selection difficulty / memory recall issues

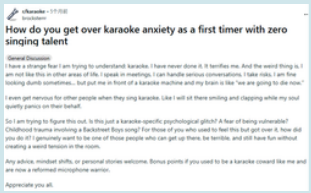
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Douyin • Date: 2024-08-12 (Anhui) • Topic: Negative physical experience after singing at KTV • Area: vocal strain / song difficulty / physical impact	 Users feel vocal strain after singing high-pitched songs in KTV	• The user describes feeling throat discomfort and fatigue after singing, especially due to songs with high pitch. • The user links the experience directly to singing difficulty rather than environment. • There is no direct interaction in the comment, but it reflects a common pattern of users reporting discomfort after singing demanding songs.	• Some karaoke songs may exceed users' vocal range, leading to physical strain and discomfort. • Negative physical experiences can reduce motivation to continue singing. • Song selection is not only a preference issue, but also related to vocal ability and physical limits. • This suggests a need for systems that help users choose songs within a comfortable vocal range or provide guidance.	Vocal strain / mismatch between song difficulty and user ability
• Platform: Red Note • Date: Not specified • Topic: KTV as a place for multiple activities • Area: social use/space experience	 Users see KTV as a multi-functional social space	• The user describes KTV as a place to sing, chat, rest, and "daydream". • Tone is poetic and reflective. • Shows that KTV is not only about singing. • Suggests flexible and open-ended usage of space.	• Users treat KTV as a hybrid social environment, not a single-purpose space. • Experience is valued beyond singing (relaxation, social bonding). • Suggests design should support multiple modes of engagement.	KTV as a multi-purpose social environment
• Platform: Red Note • Date: June 12, 2025 (Shanghai) • Topic: Difference between singing at home vs KTV • Area: performance/sound/environment		• Users question why singing sounds worse in KTV. • Comments mention loud volume and difficulty controlling pitch. • Poll + many comments → strong community interaction. • Tone: confused, questioning, seeking explanation. • Users compare different environments (home vs KTV).	• Karaoke environments alter vocal perception and performance. • Users may feel loss of control or confidence. • Suggests technical issues with sound systems or feedback. • Opportunity for better audio feedback/user control systems.	Performance inconsistency / sound environment issues

A 2

ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Reddit • Date: 2 months ago • Topic: Using Discord/YouTube for karaoke • Area: digital karaoke/platform adaptation	 Users use alternative digital platforms for karaoke	• Users describe using Discord + external tools for karaoke. • Some users feel confused about how it works. • Others explain complex setups (Voicemeeter, etc.). • Shows knowledge sharing and troubleshooting interaction. • Indicates high technical effort required.	• Users adapt non-karaoke platforms to create karaoke experiences. • Existing tools may not be intuitive. • There is demand for flexible, remote karaoke experiences. • Suggests an opportunity for simplified digital karaoke systems.	DIY digital karaoke / platform workaround
• Platform: Reddit • Date: 5 months ago • Topic: Karaoke anxiety for beginners • Area: emotional response/fear	 How do you get over karaoke anxiety as a first timer with zero singing talent Users experience strong anxiety before singing karaoke	• User expresses strong fear and vulnerability. • Asks the community for advice → high social interaction. • Mentions fear of judgment and embarrassment. • Even nervous watching others sing.	• Karaoke triggers performance anxiety similar to public speaking. • Fear is social and psychological, not skill-based. • Users seek community reassurance. • Suggests the design should address emotional safety.	Performance anxiety / fear of judgement
• Platform: Reddit • Date: 9 months ago • Topic: Nostalgia for Singstar / traditional karaoke • Area: physical interaction/gaming	 Users miss physical and social aspects of traditional karaoke	• User misses physical microphones and scoring systems. • Tone is nostalgic and emotional. • Mentions mobile versions feel worse. • Suggests the importance of tactile experience..	• Physical interaction enhances karaoke enjoyment. • Digital-only experiences may feel less engaging. • Suggests an opportunity for hybrid physical-digital design.	Loss of physical interaction in digital karaoke

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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Douyin • Date: 2025-09-20 (Yunnan) • Topic: Complaints about the KTV smell and environment • Area: environment/comfort		• Multiple users complain about the smell, smoke, and closed space. • Comments agree with each other → social validation. • Some users prefer staying home instead. • Indicates shared dissatisfaction.	• Environmental discomfort is a common issue. • Poor atmosphere may discourage participation. • Users compare KTV negatively with staying at home. • Suggests the need for cleaner, more comfortable environments.	Negative environmental experience
• Platform: Reddit • Date: 2 years ago • Topic: Advice for singing better at karaoke • Relevant area: song choice, confidence, performance strategy, social support	 Users choose songs strategically to reduce difficulty and gain confidence	• The user gives practical advice: choose songs within your vocal range, avoid very fast songs, sing loudly, and go on stage with a buddy. • The user recognises that song tempo, lyrical familiarity, and moral support all affect performance. • The suggestion to sing with a buddy shows that users may rely on companionship to reduce fear. • Socially, this is peer coaching: the user shares coping strategies with less confident singers.	• Users actively manage karaoke anxiety by selecting lower-risk songs and seeking social support. • Karaoke performance is shaped by preparation and confidence-building, not just singing ability. • Users may need systems that help them identify "safe" or beginner-friendly songs.	Confidence-building strategies / supportive song choice
• Platform: Reddit • Date: 4 years ago • Topic: Advice on how to introduce karaoke into a bar setting • Relevant area: venue compatibility, audience fit, karaoke as business/service	 Users view karaoke as something that must fit the venue and crowd	• The user sees karaoke as dependent on venue type, customer expectations, and atmosphere. • Karaoke is framed as both an entertainment service and a business tool for attracting customers. • The post suggests that karaoke should not be treated as universally suitable; it must match the social context. • Socially, this kind of post functions as peer mentoring and knowledge sharing within a community.	• Karaoke experiences are strongly shaped by venue culture and crowd expectations. • Successful karaoke depends on social fit, not just equipment or willingness to sing. • Karaoke is sometimes used strategically to increase attendance, which means business goals and user experience may intersect. • This suggests that karaoke design must consider the surrounding environment and audience type, not just the act of singing.	Context fit / karaoke depends on venue and audience culture

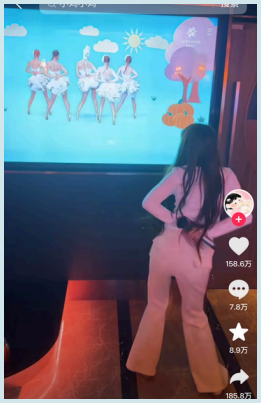
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Reddit • Date: 3 months ago • Topic: A user is upset about a karaoke system change that removed access to preferred Japanese songs • Relevant area: song library, system change, language preference, emotional attachment	 Users feel distressed when karaoke systems remove songs that support their identity and comfort	• The user describes themselves as an aspiring vocalist who relied on a specific system because it included songs they felt comfortable singing. • The system change is described not as a minor inconvenience but as a serious loss. • The post reflects a strong dependency on karaoke systems for access to specific music preferences.	• Karaoke systems are not neutral tools; they shape users' access to identity-relevant and confidence-supporting songs. • Removing certain song libraries can make users feel excluded or unsupported.. • This suggests that system changes in karaoke can have emotional and participatory consequences, especially for niche users.	Song library dependence / emotional impact of losing preferred songs
• Platform: Red Note • Date: November 20, 2025 (Hubei) • Topic: A user asks whether going to KTV alone is dangerous • Relevant area: solo karaoke, safety, anxiety, privacy	 Users want solo karaoke but worry about safety and social anxiety	• The user explicitly links wanting to go alone with being socially anxious.. • The user wants the freedom of solo karaoke but is unsure whether the environment is safe. • This indicates that solo participation is attractive, but also emotionally and socially risky. • It reflects a repeated pattern in karaoke discussions: users want more private forms of participation but are uncertain about the space.	• Solo karaoke may appeal to socially anxious users because it reduces performance pressure. • However, concerns about safety, unpredictability, or unfamiliar environments may prevent participation. • Users need both emotional safety and physical safety in karaoke spaces. • This suggests a design opportunity around privacy, solo-user support, and clearer reassurance about space and boundaries.	Solo karaoke / safety concerns and socially anxious participation
• Platform: Red Note • Date: 2025-12-12 (Guangdong) • Topic: A user describes being unable to sing full songs properly and instead contributing through group atmosphere • Relevant area: confidence, alternative participation, self-positioning in karaoke groups	 Users who lack confidence often participate as atmosphere-builders rather than main singers	• The user says they often get lyrics wrong, mess up the beat, and only sing parts of songs. • The tone is humorous but self-deprecating. • Instead of fully withdrawing, the user describes themselves as contributing to the vibe by drinking, shouting along, and joining in loosely. • This suggests adaptive participation rather than total avoidance. • The post reflects a non-performer role within karaoke groups.	• Some users do not participate through formal singing, but through energy, humour, and group support. • Karaoke participation is broader than taking the microphone and performing well. • Users may develop alternative roles to stay included despite low confidence or skill. • This suggests karaoke design could better acknowledge atmosphere-building as a valid form of participation.	Alternative participation / contributing to group atmosphere instead of performing

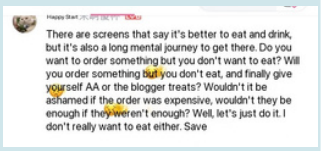
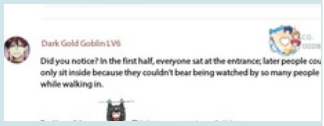
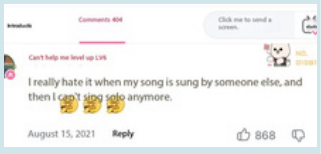
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Red Note • Date: March 2, 2024 (Fujian) • Topic: A user says they are now afraid to go to KTV because of going off-key • Relevant area: fear of failure, performance anxiety, embarrassment	 Users avoid KTV because they are afraid of singing out of tune	The user directly links being out of tune with avoiding KTV entirely.	• Fear of singing badly can become strong enough to stop users from participating at all. • Vocal insecurity is a major barrier to karaoke engagement. • This suggests design opportunities around emotional safety, support, and low-pressure participation.	Performance anxiety / fear of singing out of tune
• Platform: Douyin • Date: March 26, 2025 • Topic: Two users perform a duet or battle-style sing-off in KTV • Relevant area: duet interaction, playful competition, co-performance	 Users use duet singing to create playful competition and shared performance	• The two users appear to be singing face-to-face in a highly energetic way. • This indicates that karaoke can support co-performance and social bonding through playful exaggeration. • Socially, this kind of clip turns karaoke into a shareable, performative spectacle for others to watch online.	• Karaoke often functions as a collaborative and theatrical activity rather than a purely musical one. • Playful competition can become a form of bonding and entertainment. • This suggests design opportunities for duet modes, co-performance features, or interaction patterns that encourage shared expression.	Collaborative performance / duet-based interaction
• Platform: Douyin • Date: March 26, 2025 • Topic: Users in KTV follow the music video choreography while singing and moving with the song • Relevant area: embodied participation, movement, MV-guided interaction, playful performance	 Users follow the on-screen MV choreography	• The users are not only singing, but also copying the movements shown on the screen. • Their participation is coordinated with the visual content of the MV, showing that the screen is not just for lyrics but also a guide for movement. • This turns karaoke into a more active, body-based experience rather than a purely vocal one. • The behaviour suggests that some users enjoy karaoke through imitation, performance, and shared physical energy.	• Karaoke can become a dance-based and embodied activity when users engage with the MV as a performance guide. • The visual content on screen plays an important role in shaping user behaviour. • This suggests a design opportunity for karaoke interfaces that support movement, choreography-following, and more physically interactive participation.	Embodied participation / following the MV through movement

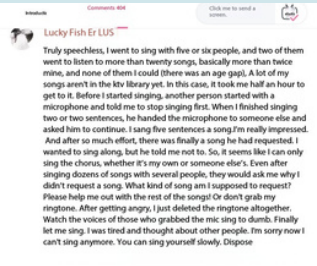
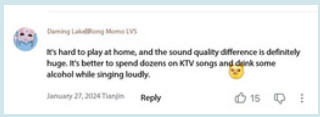
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Bilibili • Date: 2023-04-09 • Topic: A user discusses the social awkwardness of ordering food and drinks in KTV • Relevant research area: group decision-making, social anxiety, cost-sharing, participation barriers in karaoke settings	 "Some comments said that eating something and drinking a little would make it better, but even getting to that point involves a long mental process. It goes something like: should I order something? But what if other people do not want it? What if I order it and nobody eats it, and in the end I still have to split the bill for it? Or is the host paying? If I order something expensive, would that be embarrassing? If I order too little, would it be not enough? In the end, I just give up and decide I do not really want it anymore."	• The user describes ordering food and drinks in KTV as socially stressful rather than simple. • Their thought process focuses heavily on other people's preferences and reactions. • Cost-sharing and uncertainty about who is paying create hesitation. • The user eventually gives up on ordering because the decision feels too awkward and mentally exhausting. • Participation in KTV involves not only singing but also negotiating group norms around consumption.	• KTV experiences may include hidden social friction beyond the act of singing itself. • Group settings can make simple actions, such as ordering snacks or drinks, emotionally burdensome. • Users may suppress their own needs in order to avoid embarrassment or disturbing group harmony. • This suggests that karaoke environments are shaped by unspoken social rules around spending, sharing, and decision-making.	Social awkwardness in group decision-making / hidden participation barriers
• Platform: Bilibili • Date: 2023-04-05 • Topic: A user describes seating behaviour and discomfort with being watched in karaoke rooms • Relevant research area: social anxiety, spatial behaviour, visibility, comfort in group karaoke settings	 "Have you noticed that introverted people tend to sit near the door first, and those who come later can only sit further inside, because introverted people cannot handle walking to the inner seats under so many people's gaze. That short walk feels extremely painful."	• The user notices a repeated seating pattern linked to personality and comfort. • Sitting near the door is framed as a coping strategy for introverted participants. • Being watched while entering or moving through the room is experienced as stressful. • Even a short physical movement within the room is described as emotionally intense. • Spatial position in karaoke rooms appears to affect comfort and willingness to participate.	• Karaoke spaces are not socially neutral; room layout and visibility can intensify anxiety. • Introverted users may manage discomfort through spatial choices, such as selecting low-exposure seating. • The karaoke experience begins before singing, with room entry and seating already shaping emotional comfort. • This suggests that design should consider not only singing interfaces but also arrival, positioning, and low-pressure ways of entering group settings.	Social visibility and spatial anxiety
• Platform: Bilibili • Date: 2021-08-15 • Topic: A user expresses frustration about others singing their selected song • Relevant research area: turn-taking, ownership, control, interpersonal tension in karaoke participation	 "I really hate it when someone else sings the song I picked, and then I no longer get to sing it solo."	• The user feels strong frustration when others join in on a song they selected. • The complaint suggests an expectation of personal control or ownership over the chosen song. • Singing solo appears to hold emotional or performative value for the user. • The issue reflects tension between individual expression and shared group participation. • The tone is direct and emotionally charged.	• Karaoke participation may involve unspoken expectations around song ownership and performance rights. • Conflict can emerge when group collaboration interrupts a user's desired personal performance moment. • Some users may value karaoke as a space for self-expression rather than collective singing. • This suggests that karaoke systems and social norms may need to better support turn clarity, role expectations, or different participation preferences.	Song ownership / tension between solo performance and group participation

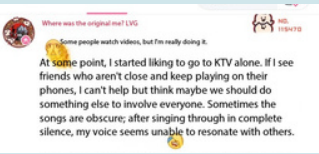
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Bilibili • Date: 2021-08-15 • Topic: frustration with unfair turn-taking, song queue control, and microphone dominance in KTV • Relevant research area: turn-taking, queue fairness, song ownership, group coordination in karaoke		• The user describes strong frustration with unfair song queue management. • A small number of participants dominate both the song list and microphone time. • The user experiences a long wait before getting a chance to sing. • The available song library does not match the user's music preferences. • The complaint combines several issues: limited catalogue, weak turn-taking rules, and mic domination. • The tone is highly emotional and indicates accumulated resentment.	• Karaoke participation is shaped not only by singing ability, but also by how fairly turns, songs, and devices are managed. • Poor queue visibility and weak turn-taking norms can make some users feel excluded even when they are physically present in the group. • A mismatch between song library content and users' generational or personal preferences can deepen the sense of exclusion. • Karaoke may fail as a collaborative social experience when a few dominant participants control the flow.	Queue unfairness / microphone domination / exclusion in group karaoke
• Platform: Bilibili • Date: 2025-08-11 • Topic: a user feels embarrassed singing because their voice blends into the original track • Relevant research area: singing confidence, self-consciousness, audio feedback, participation anxiety in karaoke	 "I want to ask everyone something. I went to KTV with friends three times this summer, and I noticed that when I sing, my voice blends into the original track. My voice becomes very quiet, almost like I am not singing at all. But I cannot separate from the original vocal because I go off-key a bit and I think my voice sounds unpleasant, so I feel embarrassed to sing loudly. How can I improve this?"	• The user is self-conscious about both pitch accuracy and vocal quality. • They deliberately keep their voice quiet to avoid being heard clearly. • The original track acts as a form of cover or protection. • The user still wants to participate, but in a low-exposure way. • The comment shows a gap between willingness to join and confidence in performing.	• Karaoke does not always function as a confident performance space; for some users, it is a site of self-monitoring and anxiety. • Users may rely on the original vocal track as emotional and acoustic protection. • Participation in karaoke can be partial, hidden, or intentionally low-volume rather than fully expressive. • This suggests design opportunities around confidence support, vocal guidance, adjustable accompaniment.	Singing anxiety / low-confidence participation
• Platform: Bilibili • Date: 2024-01-27 • Topic: a user compares home karaoke with going to KTV and prefers the KTV atmosphere • Relevant research area: environmental experience, sound quality, ambience, value perception in karaoke	 "At home you just cannot fully let go, and the sound quality is definitely much worse too. It still feels better to spend a few dozen yuan to go to KTV, order songs, have a little alcohol, and sing freely."	• The user sees home karaoke as less freeing than going to KTV. • Sound quality is described as a major difference between home and venue-based singing. • KTV is associated with openness, release, and enjoyment. • The user considers the cost of going to KTV worthwhile. • The experience includes not just singing, but ambience and possibly drinks/social mood.	• Karaoke value is strongly tied to environmental conditions, not just music playback. • Users may prefer KTV because it creates a psychologically different space from home, where they feel more permitted to perform freely. • Sound quality, lighting, room atmosphere, and social mood appear to shape enjoyment and perceived value. • This suggests that karaoke design should be understood as an environmental and experiential system, rather than only a singing interface.	Environmental immersion / value of venue-based karaoke

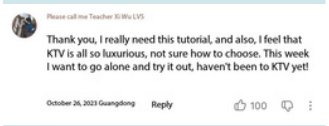
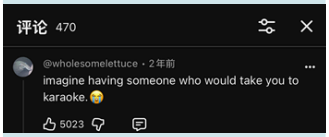
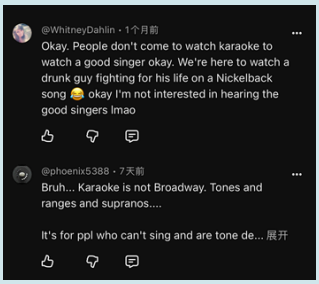
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Bilibili • Date: 2022-11-22 • Topic: users feel it is harder for groups to enjoy karaoke together because music tastes are more fragmented • Relevant research area: shared song choice, group cohesion, collective participation in karaoke	 "In the past, there were always popular songs that everyone knew, so when people went singing together they could all resonate with them and sing along. Now it is mostly niche idol singers and everyone likes different music. Each person sings songs by artists that others have never even heard of. It feels like you are just keeping someone company for nothing, and the whole situation becomes awkward."	• The user compares past karaoke experiences with current ones. • Shared familiarity with songs is seen as important for group enjoyment. • Fragmented music taste is described as making participation harder. • The user connects unfamiliar songs with awkwardness and reduced group resonance. • The issue is not only about song quantity, but about whether songs are socially shared.	• Karaoke depends partly on shared cultural knowledge, not just individual song choice. • When music preferences become highly personalised, group karaoke may lose its collective energy. • A successful karaoke experience may require balancing personal expression with songs that enable wider group participation. • This suggests that karaoke systems could better support shared-discovery features, group-friendly song recommendations, or ways to identify songs.	Fragmented music taste / loss of shared group resonance
• Platform: Bilibili • Date: 2025-03-06 • Topic: a user strongly enjoys singing alone in KTV for a long period of time • Relevant research area: solo karaoke, private enjoyment, self-directed participation, alternative karaoke use	 "KTV is really a magical place. Once I sang alone in KTV for six hours, and it honestly felt amazing. I wished I could go once every week."	• The user frames KTV as a highly enjoyable personal space. • Singing alone for an extended period is described positively rather than as lonely. • The user values the intensity and satisfaction of uninterrupted solo singing. • KTV is experienced here as a place for release and immersion, not necessarily group socialising. • The comment challenges the assumption that karaoke is always a collective activity.	• Karaoke can function as a private emotional outlet, not just a group entertainment format. • Some users may prefer karaoke precisely because it allows uninterrupted, self-paced performance. • Solo karaoke suggests that privacy, autonomy, and control can be central design values. • This opens up opportunities to rethink karaoke beyond social coordination, including how spaces and interfaces could support personal immersion and long-form solo use.	Solo karaoke / private immersive participation
• Platform: Bilibili • Date: 2025-02-20 • Topic: a user explains why they now prefer going to KTV alone instead of with unfamiliar friends • Relevant research area: social pressure, participation mismatch, solo karaoke as adaptation, comfort in karaoke settings	 "At some point, I realised I preferred going to KTV alone. When I go with friends, especially people I am not very close to, and I see them constantly on their phones, I cannot help but think whether I should do something else to get everyone involved. Sometimes my songs are too niche, and after I finish singing there is complete silence, and it feels like my singing cannot create any resonance with others. So I finally understood. The first time I went alone, I felt awkward even at the front desk, especially when they asked how many people and I answered 'one.' Looking at the empty KTV felt strange at first, but after singing a few songs I got used to it. Singing alone for three or four hours can still be tiring, so I bring a notebook and pen. Sometimes after singing for a while, I want to write something down and take a break."	• The user feels pressure to maintain group engagement when attending karaoke with others. • Unfamiliar companions and low responsiveness reduce the pleasure of singing. • Singing niche songs in silence is experienced as socially unrewarding. • The user shifts to solo karaoke as a strategy for reducing awkwardness and mismatch. • Even solo karaoke involves a small barrier at the beginning, such as admitting to the front desk that they are alone.	• Karaoke discomfort may come not only from singing itself, but from managing other people's attention and response. • Solo karaoke can be understood as a coping strategy when group participation feels mismatched or emotionally draining. • The awkwardness of "going alone" suggests that social norms still frame KTV as a collective activity, even when solo use is meaningful. • Users may benefit from services, spaces, and interfaces that more explicitly support solo attendance without stigma.	Solo karaoke as relief from group pressure

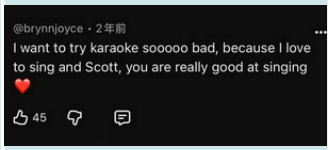
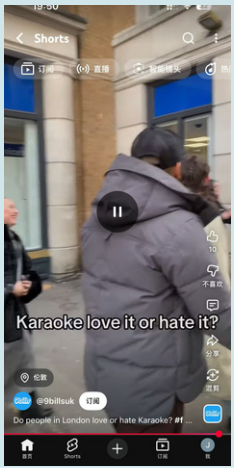
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Bilibili • Date: 2023-10-26 • Topic: a first-time user feels unsure about how to choose and use KTV alone • Relevant research area: first-time user experience, accessibility, solo karaoke entry barriers, service clarity		• The user needs instructional guidance before visiting KTV. • KTV is perceived as visually impressive but also intimidating. • Choosing a venue feels confusing for a first-time user. • The user is interested in solo karaoke but lacks confidence about the process. • The barrier is not singing itself, but understanding how to enter and navigate the experience.	• Karaoke can feel inaccessible to first-time or inexperienced users, especially when service structures are unclear. • The visual style of KTV venues may communication luxury, but also unintentionally raise psychological barriers. • Solo karaoke requires not only privacy but also confidence in how booking, room choice, and etiquette work. • This suggests that karaoke services and interfaces could better support onboarding, venue comparison, and first-time guidance.	First-time anxiety / entry barriers to solo karaoke
• Platform: Youtube • Date: 2 years ago • Topic: karaoke is imagined as a meaningful social activity someone would share with you • Relevant research area: social bonding, companionship, karaoke as relational experience		• The comment frames karaoke as something done with another person rather than alone. • The emotional tone suggests longing, softness, and romantic or relational desire. • Being “taken to karaoke” is positioned as a meaningful gesture of care or companionship. • Karaoke here is not described as a technical activity, but as a social experience tied to closeness.	• Karaoke may hold social meaning beyond entertainment, functioning as a site of bonding and relational intimacy. • For some users, the appeal of karaoke lie not only in singing, but in who they go with. • This suggests that karaoke is embedded in friendship, dating, or companionship rituals. • Designing for karaoke could therefore consider not only performance and song selection, but also invitation, accompaniment, and shared memory-making.	Karaoke as companionship / relational bonding
• Platform: Youtube • Date: 1 month ago • Topic: users argue that karaoke is about fun and spectacle rather than vocal excellence • Relevant research area: participation norms, performance expectations, low-pressure karaoke culture		• The commenters reject professional-level expectations in karaoke. • Entertainment value is linked to imperfection, humour, and spontaneity. • “Good singing” is positioned as less important than the energy of the moment. • The social norm described here values inclusiveness over technical skill. • Karaoke is framed as participatory fun, not elite performance.	• Karaoke culture may deliberately resist standards associated with formal performance. • Users may feel more comfortable participating when imperfection is accepted or even celebrated. • The appeal of karaoke can lie in looseness, humour, and collective enjoyment rather than polished output. • This suggests that karaoke systems and experiences should support low-pressure participation rather than amplify competitive evaluation.	Low-pressure participation / fun over technical skill

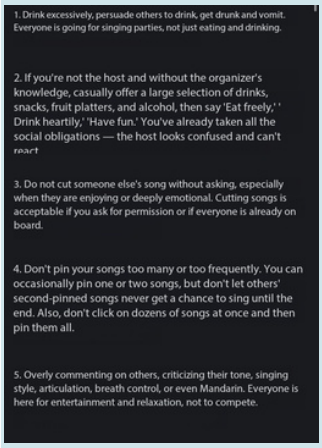
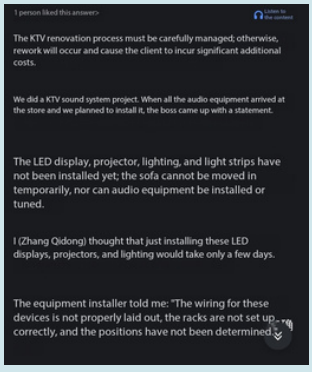
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: YouTube • Date: 2 years ago / 1 year ago comments visible • Topic: viewers discussing duet karaoke and the appeal of singing together • Relevant research area: duet participation, aspiration to try karaoke, shared performance, social enjoyment		• The commenter expresses strong desire to try karaoke. • Singing ability is noticed and appreciated in duet settings. • Duets appear attractive because they combine performance with shared participation. • The tone is positive, playful, and encouraging. • Karaoke is framed here as exciting and socially appealing rather than stressful.	• Karaoke can be aspirational, especially when users see others having fun in duet formats. • Duet karaoke may lower participation barriers by allowing users to share the spotlight rather than perform alone. • Shared singing can function as both entertainment and social bonding. • This suggests that duet modes may be an important entry point for users who enjoy singing but may not want solo exposure.	Duet karaoke / shared participation as attraction
• Platform: YouTube Shorts / street interview context • Date: 1 month ago • Topic: public attitudes toward whether people love or hate karaoke • Relevant research area: public perception, attitude diversity, social acceptance of karaoke		• The video frames karaoke as a divisive social activity rather than something universally enjoyed. • The question assumes that users may have strong emotional reactions to karaoke, either positive or negative. • Karaoke is presented as a public cultural topic that can be discussed beyond the venue itself. • The street interview format suggests that karaoke is socially recognisable enough to provoke quick opinions. • The data implies that karaoke carries different meanings for different people.	• Karaoke is not a neutral entertainment format; it may trigger enthusiasm, discomfort, embarrassment, or nostalgia depending on the person. • Public opinion on karaoke likely reflects broader difference in personality, confidence, social preference, and cultural familiarity. • The fact that karaoke can be both loved and hated suggests it contains both strong attractions and strong barriers.	Polarised attitudes toward karaoke
• Platform: YouTube • Date: 7 months ago / 4 months ago visible comments • Topic: users discussing a common group karaoke problem: friends singing over you • Relevant research area: interruption, turn-taking, song ownership, collaborative vs competitive participation		• The commenter identifies "singing over others" as a negative part of group karaoke. • Friends joining in is framed here as interruption rather than support. • The tone is casual and humorous, but the complaint points to a repeated social issue. • Group karaoke can blur the boundary between collaboration and taking over someone's moment. • The concern is less about technical singing and more about respect for turns and presence.	• Karaoke involves fragile social boundaries around when joining in feels supportive and when it feels intrusive. • Group participation is not automatically positive; it depends on timing, consent, and shared expectations. • Some users may want collaborative singing, while others want their own performance space protected. • This suggests karaoke systems and environments could better support role clarity, duet invitations, or visible turn ownership.	Singing over others / blurred boundaries in group participation

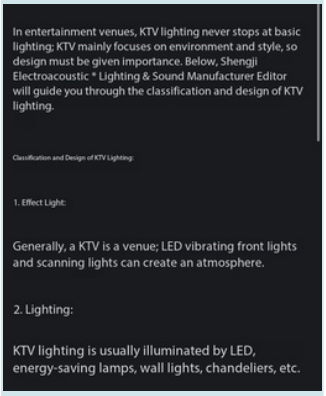
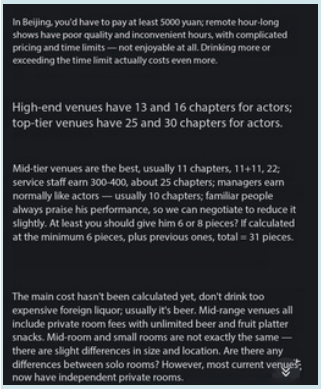
A 2

ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Zhihu • Date: 2019-04-14 • Topic: A user feels ignored and frustrated in KTV because others keep topping their own songs and dominating the queue • Relevant research area: queue fairness, mic domination, emotional exclusion in group karaoke		• The user spends much of the KTV session waiting rather than singing. • Other participants repeatedly manipulate the queue by topping their own songs. • The user describes "mic-hogs" as a major barrier to participation. • The emotional tone becomes much stronger in the later part of the post, shifting from annoyance to sadness. • Singing is clearly important to this user personally, so being unable to participate feels genuinely upsetting.	• Queue unfairness in karaoke is not just an efficiency issue; it can become an emotional exclusion issue. • When a few people dominate turns, other users may feel invisible even while physically sharing the same room. • Karaoke is supposed to be participatory and enjoyable, but bad turn management can turn it into passive waiting. • This suggests that fair queue systems, transparent turn order, and protection against repeated topping are very important.	Queue domination and emotional exclusion
• Platform: Zhihu • Date: 2018-11-20 • Topic: A user lists common KTV behaviours that annoy others and break group etiquette • Relevant research area: karaoke etiquette, shared norms, group boundaries, respectful participation		• The user frames KTV as a place for relaxation rather than competition or social pressure. • Many of the listed annoyances are not technical issues, but etiquette issues. • The behaviours mentioned all involve overstepping group boundaries. • Respect for other people's songs, turns, money, and comfort is treated as very important. • The post implies that a "good" karaoke experience depends a lot on tacit social rules.	• Karaoke is shaped by informal etiquette just as much as by music or interface design. • Users do not only need songs and microphones; they also need a social environment where their boundaries are respected. • Many negative karaoke experiences seem to come from people treating the room as their own stage rather than a shared space. • This suggests that karaoke systems and services could better support group fairness, clearer norms, and shared awareness.	Karaoke etiquette and shared social boundaries
• Platform: Zhihu • Date: 2024-01-18 • Topic: A practitioner explains the setup process of building a KTV room, including wiring, soundproofing, lighting, and equipment installation • Relevant research area: environmental infrastructure, technical setup, KTV as a designed system		• KTV is built from multiple interdependent elements rather than a single device. • Audio equipment cannot simply be installed on its own; it depends on the completion of lighting, wiring, furniture placement, and room structure. • The post highlights the backstage complexity of what users later experience as a simple karaoke room. • This source feels more like contextual or industry insight than user complaint.	• Karaoke experience is deeply shaped by environmental infrastructure, not only by interface or song selection. • The quality of a KTV session may depend on how well soundproofing, wiring, display placement, lighting, and room layout are coordinated. • For design research, this means environmental and technical conditions are part of the user experience, even if users do not always see them directly.	KTV as an integrated environmental system

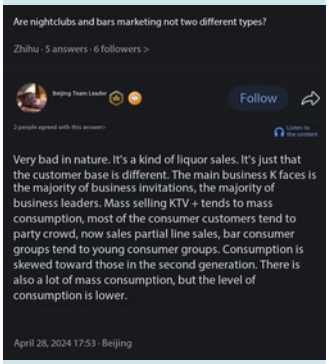
A 2

ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Zhihu • Date: 2021-03-29 • Topic: a post about KTV lighting design and how atmosphere is central to KTV spaces • Relevant research area: lighting, ambience, environmental design in karaoke spaces		• The post explicitly positions atmosphere as a core part of the KTV experience. • Lighting is described as more than functional; it is used to create mood and style. • Multiple types of lighting are mentioned, suggesting layered environmental design. • This source treats KTV as a designed entertainment environment rather than only a place to sing. • The emphasis is on ambience-building rather than user behaviour.	• Karaoke experience depends partly on atmosphere, not only on songs or interfaces. • Lighting may strongly influence how immersive, exciting, or comfortable a karaoke room feels. • This supports the idea that KTV should be analysed as an environmental experience system. • For design, this means environmental elements like colour, brightness, and effects are part of participation, not just decoration.	Lighting and atmosphere as part of karaoke experience
• Platform: Zhihu • Date: 2026-02-02 • Topic: a response discussing how high KTV spending can be in Chengdu • Relevant research area: cost, perceived expense, financial barriers to karaoke participation		• The answer normalises very high KTV spending in certain cities. • Cost is framed as location-dependent and structurally expected rather than unusual. • The tone is matter-of-fact, suggesting that expensive KTV is accepted in some contexts. • This source points to pricing as a contextual condition of KTV use. • Unlike emotional user complaints, this answer sounds more like market knowledge.	• Karaoke is not only a social or entertainment activity; it is also shaped by affordability. • High price may influence who can participate, how often they go, and what kind of expectations they bring. • Users may judge KTV value not only by fun, but by whether the experience feels worth the money. • This supports earlier comments about KTV being "expensive" and helps explain why value-for-money becomes important.	Cost and affordability of karaoke
• Platform: Zhihu • Date: 2025-12-16 • Topic: a detailed answer explaining the typical cost structure of going to KTV with friends in Beijing • Relevant research area: pricing structure, hidden costs, group spending, practical barriers to karaoke outing		• The answer describes KTV pricing as complicated and layered. • Cost is not only the room fee, but also includes time limits, drinks, staff tips, and other add-on expenses. • Lower-cost options are associated with worse quality and inconvenience. • Spending more appears tied to comfort, convenience, and overall experience quality. • This source presents KTV as a relatively high-commitment outing rather than a casual cheap activity.	• Karaoke participation may be limited not only by confidence or group dynamics, but also by complicated and high spending requirements. • Price complexity may create uncertainty before the experience even begins, especially for younger users or students. • This suggests that affordability and pricing transparency are important parts of karaoke accessibility. • It also shows that "going to KTV" includes logistical and economic decision-making, not just social willingness.	Price complexity and participation barriers

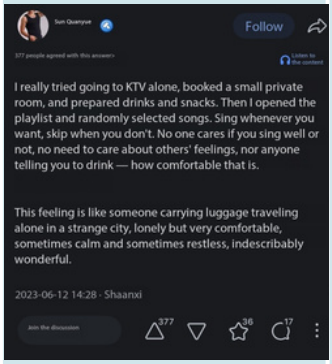
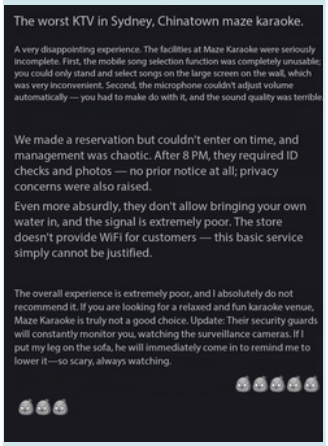
A 2

ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Zhihu • Date: 2024-04-28 • Topic: a post comparing nightlife marketing, bars, and mass-market KTV • Relevant research area: target audience, customer profile, consumption pattern in karaoke venues		• The post describes mass-market KTV as mainly serving group-based social consumption. • KTV is positioned differently from bars in terms of audience and spending level. • Online sales are mentioned as part of current KTV business practice.	• Karaoke is framed here as a mainstream group activity rather than a niche nightlife format. • This suggests that KTV design may need to prioritise coordination, accessibility, and group convenience. • It also shows that karaoke participation is shaped by venue type and target audience.	KTV as mainstream group entertainment
• Platform: Zhihu • Date: 2025-04-19 • Topic: an explanatory post introducing KTV types and defining business-style vs mass-market KTV • Relevant research area: KTV typology, venue difference, service model		• The post defines KTV as both a singing and social space. • It distinguishes clearly between mass-market and business-style KTV. • Different venue types are linked to different user groups and service expectations.	• Karaoke is not one single experience; it varies depending on venue type. • This suggests that user needs, expectations, and behaviours may differ a lot across KTV contexts. • It is useful background for deciding which karaoke context a design project should focus on.	Different KTV types and user contexts
• Platform: Zhihu • Date: 2022-05-21 • Topic: a user shares a positive solo KTV experience in a small room • Relevant research area: solo karaoke, emotional release, gradual comfort, self-paced participation		• The user describes solo KTV as highly satisfying. • There is slight nervousness at first, but it fades over time. • The experience becomes more enjoyable as the user relaxes.	• Solo karaoke can offer emotional release and strong personal enjoyment. • Initial awkwardness does not necessarily stop participation if the environment feels safe enough. • This suggests solo KTV may be an important mode for users who want autonomy and low-pressure singing.	Positive solo karaoke experience

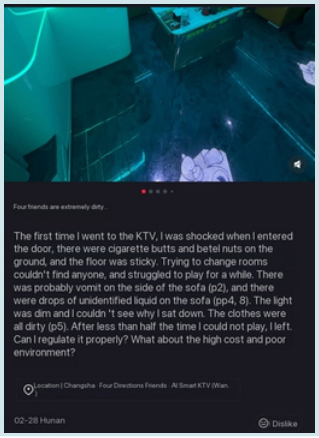
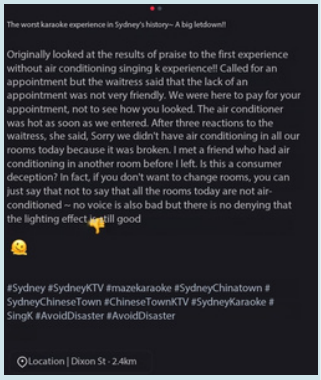
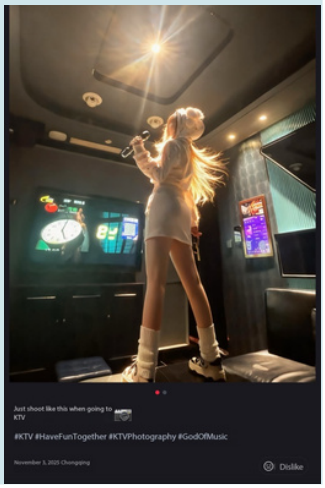
A 2

ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: Zhihu • Date: 2023-06-12 • Topic: a user shares a highly positive experience of going to KTV alone • Relevant research area: solo karaoke, emotional comfort, autonomy, low-pressure participation		• The user describes solo KTV as highly free and self-directed. • They value being able to choose, skip, and sing entirely at their own pace. • The absence of judgement, social pressure, and drinking pressure is framed as a major benefit. • The emotional tone is surprisingly rich: the user describes the experience as both solitary and comforting. • Solo karaoke is not described as second-best, but as a uniquely satisfying mode of participation.	• Solo karaoke may fulfil needs that group karaoke often cannot, especially autonomy, emotional comfort, and freedom from social monitoring. • This suggests that some users are not trying to escape karaoke itself, but are instead looking for a version of karaoke that feels more personal and less socially demanding. • The comparison to solo travel implies that karaoke can function as a reflective and emotionally immersive activity, not only as group entertainment.	Solo karaoke as comfort and autonomy
• Platform: Xiaohongshu • Date: 2024-03-21 • Topic: a user posts a strongly negative review of a karaoke venue in Melbourne, describing poor facilities, management, and privacy concerns • Relevant research area: venue usability, service quality, privacy, trust, infrastructure in karaoke spaces		• The user's complaint covers several layers of the experience at once: interface failure, audio control, entry management, and privacy. • Mobile song selection is expected, and its failure is experienced as a major inconvenience. • The inability to adjust microphone volume suggests low user control over the singing experience. • Hidden rules, ID checks, and being monitored by security create discomfort beyond the act of singing.	• A bad karaoke experience may come from the accumulation of many small system failures rather than one single dramatic issue. • Users seem to expect karaoke venues to support convenience, personal control, and a sense of safety; when these break down, the whole experience feels hostile. • Privacy and trust matter in karaoke more than people might assume, especially because users are already in a semi-private, potentially vulnerable setting.	Service breakdown, loss of control, and privacy anxiety
• Platform: Xiaohongshu • Date: 2026-03-13 • Topic: a user criticises an AI karaoke competition feature, arguing that it pushes spending and makes the game system feel unfair • Relevant research area: gamification, monetisation, scoring systems, fairness, consumption pressure in karaoke platforms		• The user is not rejecting competition itself, but the way the competition is tied to spending. • Scoring is seen as less meaningful when paid gifts directly affect results. • The PK feature turns food and drink into part of the game mechanic. • The complaint also reveals that some users already prefer bringing their own snacks rather than purchasing from the venue.	• Karaoke gamification can backfire when users feel that money, rather than singing, determines the outcome. • Features that are meant to increase engagement may instead reduce trust if they are experienced as manipulative. • This suggests users want karaoke scoring and competition to feel fair, meaningful, and more connected to singing performance itself. • It also shows tension between entertainment design and venue monetisation strategies.	Monetised gamification and unfair scoring

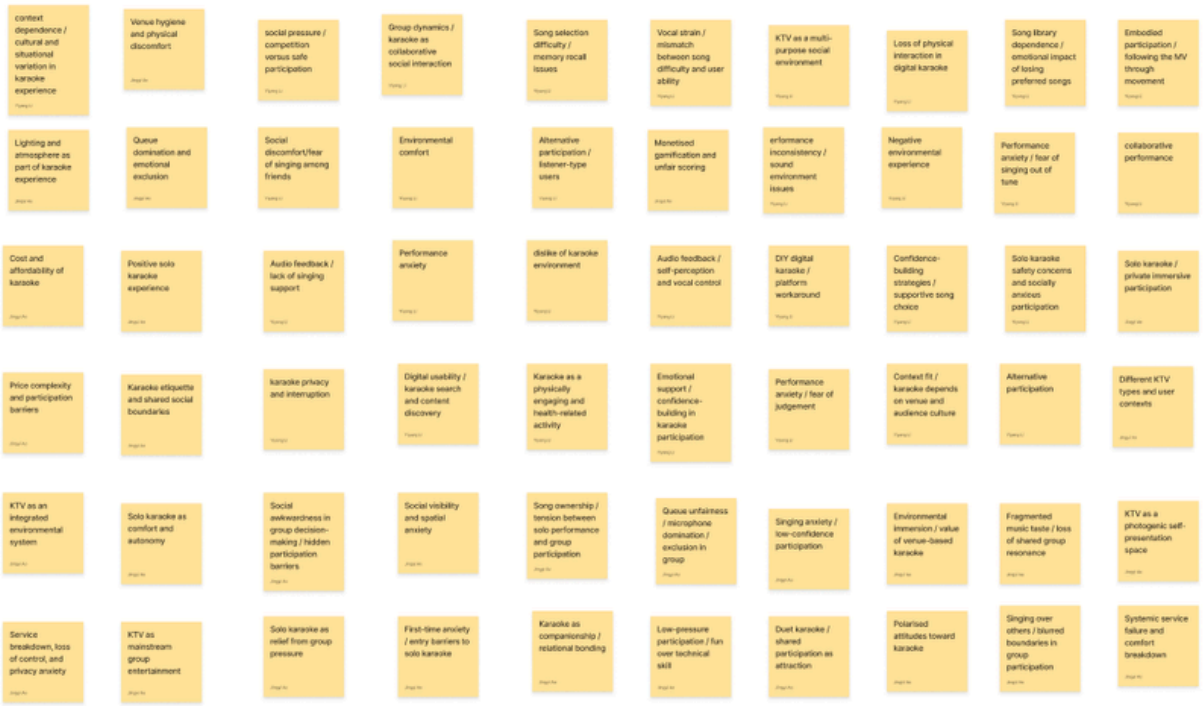
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ONLINE ETHNOGRAPHY

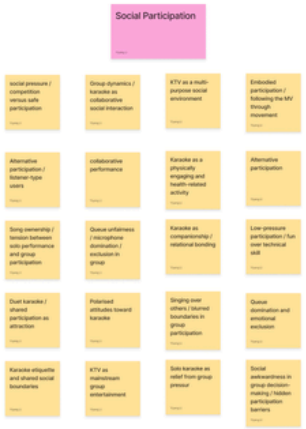
CONTEXT	DATA RECORD	RECORDED OBSERVATIONS	INTERPRETATIONS	THEME
• Platform: RedNote (Xiaohongshu) • Date: 2026-02-28 • Topic: a user complains about a karaoke venue with dirty floors, sticky surfaces, and poor room conditions • Relevant research area: cleanliness, maintenance, physical comfort, venue quality in karaoke spaces		• The complaint focuses on the physical condition of the venue. • Dirtiness and sticky surfaces are noticed immediately on entry. • Staff availability also seems poor when the user wants help.	• The complaint focuses on the physical condition of the venue. • Dirtiness and sticky surfaces are noticed immediately on entry. • Staff availability also seems poor when the user wants help.	Venue hygiene and physical discomfort
• Platform: RedNote (Xiaohongshu) • Date: 2024-03-21 • Topic: a user describes a very poor karaoke experience because of broken air conditioning, bad audio, rude service, and misleading booking communication • Relevant research area: service quality, environmental comfort, transparency, trust in karaoke venues		• The user expected a good experience because of previous positive reviews. • Environmental comfort, especially temperature, becomes a major issue. • The complaint also includes booking confusion, staff attitude, and sound quality. • Interestingly, the user still separates out one positive point: the lighting.	• A karaoke experience can fail even when some designed elements, like lighting, work well, because users experience the venue as a whole system. • Comfort, service communication, and sound quality may matter more to satisfaction than visual effects alone. • This suggests that karaoke venues need consistent baseline quality across environment, service, and technical performance, not just attractive aesthetics.	Systemic service failure and comfort breakdown
• Platform: RedNote (Xiaohongshu) • Date: 2025-11-03 • Topic: a user shares a stylised photo taken in a KTV room and presents KTV as a visually performative space • Relevant research area: photo-taking, self-presentation, visual atmosphere, KTV as a social-media-friendly environment		• The post focuses on how KTV can be used as a visually dramatic photo setting. • The user is not mainly documenting singing, but curating an image of themselves in the space. • Lighting, pose, and room design are treated as important parts of the KTV experience. • KTV is presented as both an entertainment venue and a content-production background.	• For some users, karaoke is not only about singing or socialising, but also about being seen and producing shareable content. • This suggests that visual atmosphere and photogenic room design may shape how attractive a karaoke venue feels, especially on social platforms. • KTV can function as a performative space where entertainment, identity expression, and platform aesthetics overlap. • This also means that users may evaluate a karaoke venue partly by how well it supports photos, videos, and self-staging.	KTV as a photogenic self-presentation space

A 3

USER PERSONAS







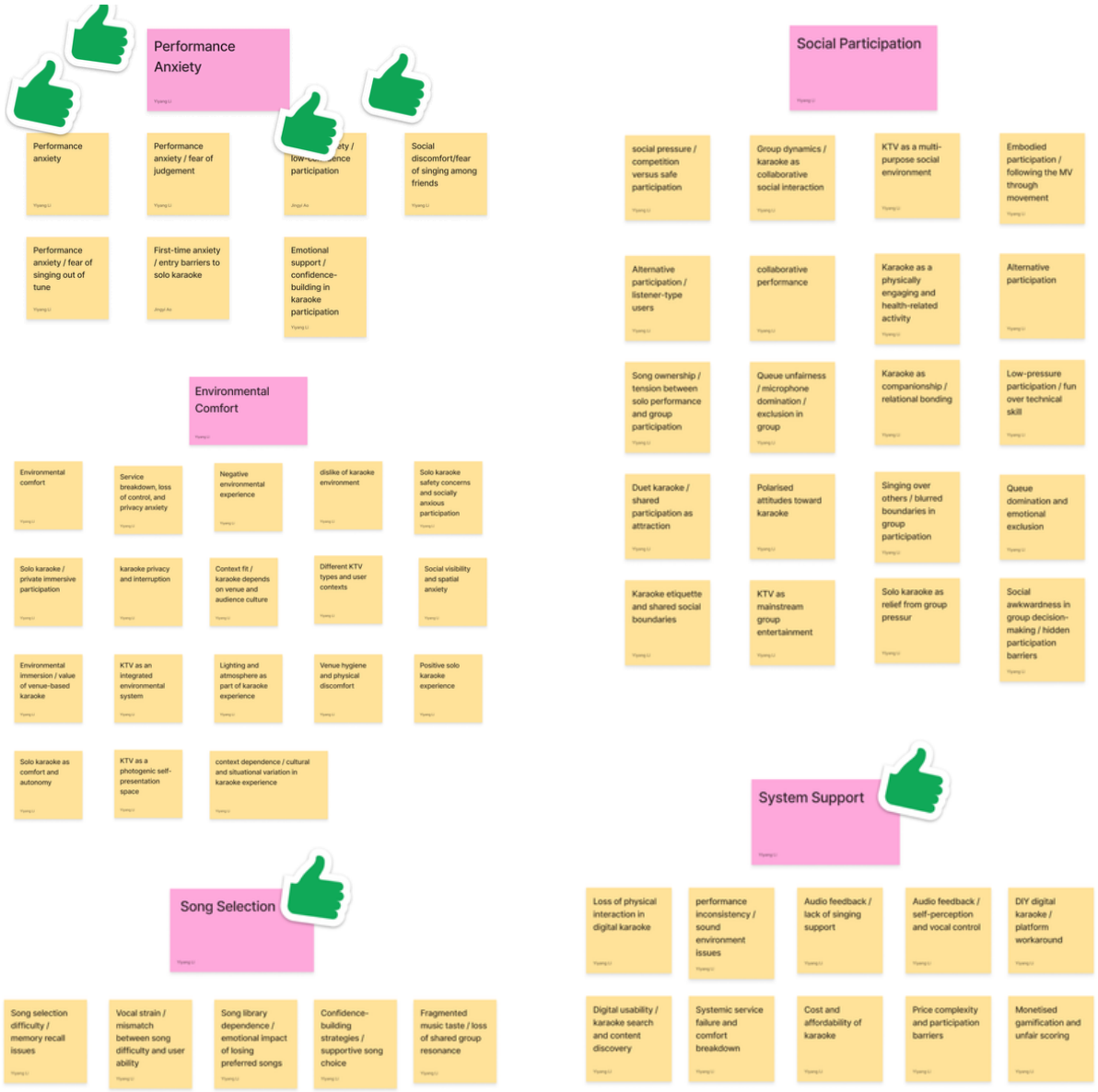






A 3

USER PERSONAS



Insights:

- The reason many people avoid karaoke is not that they dislike singing, but because their anxiety makes them feel that taking part carries a high risk and will expose their emotions.
- Anxiety about singing karaoke is influenced not only by an individual's self-confidence but also by the social context, including who is present, how others behave, and whether the atmosphere is supportive or judgmental.
- Users feel more confident when a karaoke system helps them choose songs that suit their singing ability, comfort level, and mood.

A 3

USER PERSONAS

Basic information



Mia

"The Anxious Participant"

- Age 21
- Occupation University student
- Location Sydney
- Goes to karaoke with friends
- Prefers low-pressure participation

Bio

Mia likes the social atmosphere of karaoke, but she often experiences performance anxiety. She is afraid of singing out of tune, being compared with stronger singers, or becoming awkward in front of friends. She prefers joining group choruses or singing quietly with background vocals rather than performing alone. For Mia, a good karaoke experience is one where she can participate without feeling exposed or judged.

Goal | Frustration | Need

Personality

Introvert	Extrovert
Analytical	Creative
Busy	Time rich
Messy	Organized
Independent	Team player
Passive	Active
Safe	Risky

Interests

- Karaoke with friends
- Group choruses
- Familiar songs

Influences

- Fear of judgement
- Stronger singers in the room
- Social pressure from friends

Goals

- Sing with more confidence
- Enjoy karaoke comfortably
- Join without feeling exposed

Needs and expectations

- Low-pressure participation
- Supportive group atmosphere
- Safer ways to join singing

Motivations

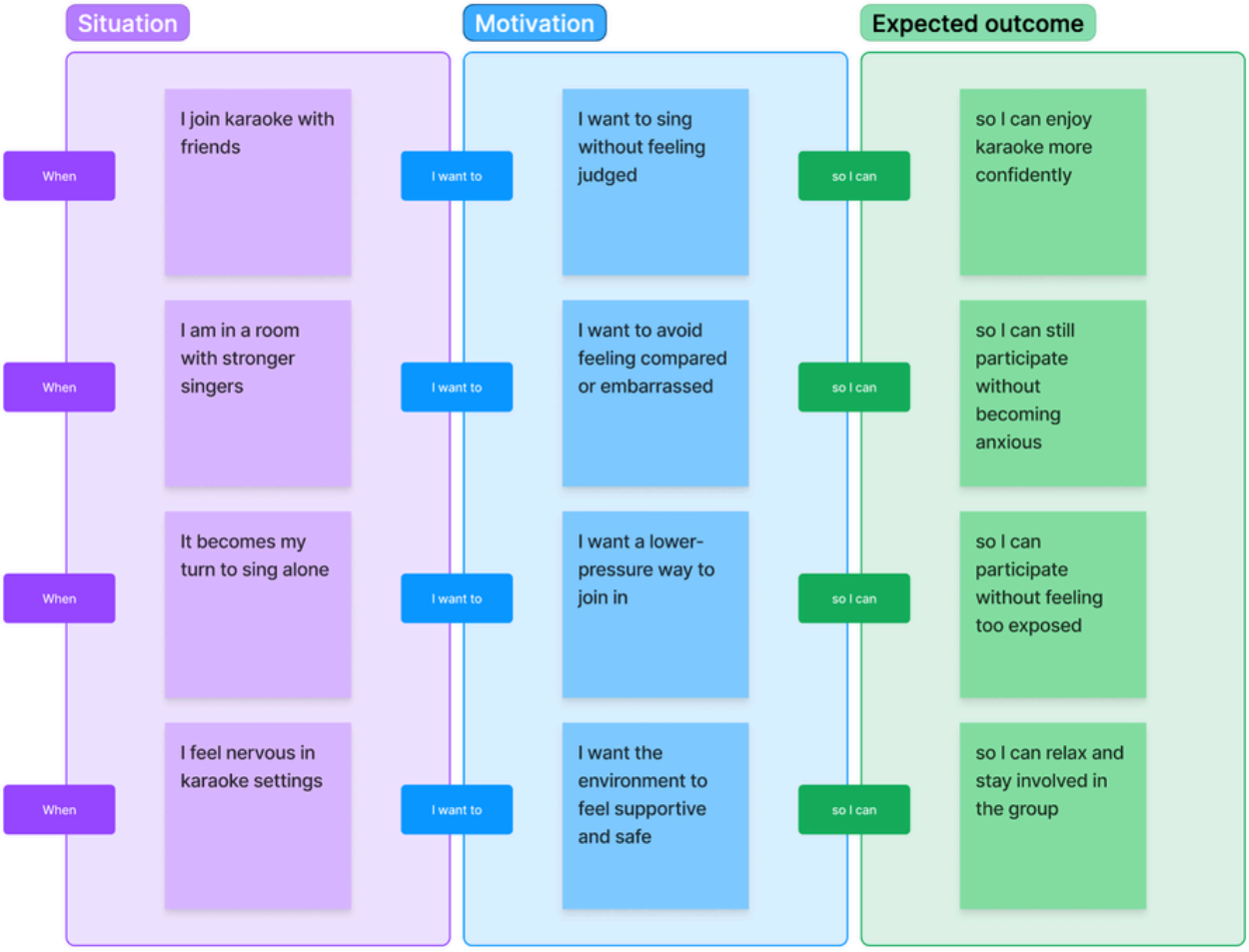
- Social belonging
- Enjoyment of music
- Comfortable participation

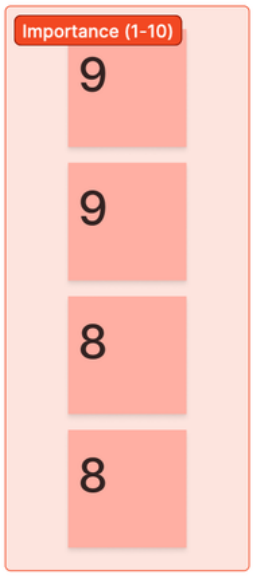
Pain points and frustrations

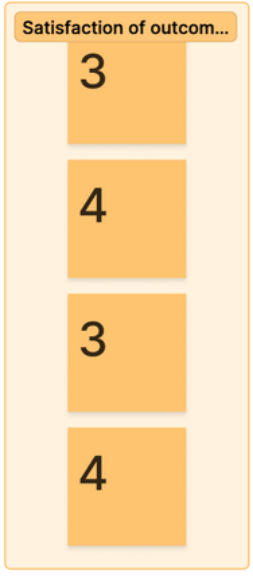
- Singing out of tune
- Being compared with others
- Solo performance anxiety

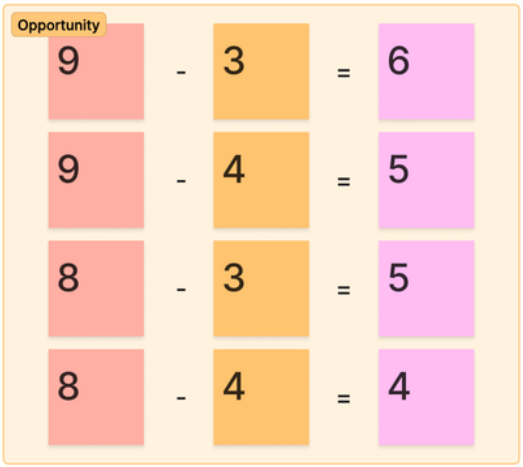
A 4

JOBS-TO-BE-DONE









A 3

USER PERSONAS

Basic information



Jason

"The Hesitant Singer"

- Age: 22
- Occupation: University student
- Location: Sydney
- Usually goes to karaoke with classmates or close friends
- Enjoys listening to music and singing, but rarely volunteers to go first
- Prefers group singing or duets over solo performance

Bio

Jason is a university student who enjoys the social atmosphere of karaoke, but often feels nervous when it is his turn to sing. He worries about sounding awkward, singing off-key, or making the moment uncomfortable. As a result, he usually waits for others to sing first or joins only during group singing. He values karaoke experiences that feel relaxed, supportive, and low-pressure rather than competitive or performance-focused.

Participation | Judgement | Confidence

Personality

Introvert	Extrovert
Analytical	Creative
Busy	Time rich
Messy	Organized
Independent	Team player
Passive	Active
Safe	Risky

Interests

- Listening to pop and familiar songs
- Hanging out with close friends
- Duets and group singing

Influences

- Friends' reactions during karaoke
- The overall mood in the room
- Whether others seem supportive or judgmental

Goals

- Join karaoke without embarrassment
- Feel included without too much attention
- Enjoy singing in a relaxed way

Needs and expectations

- Easy songs or "safe" song suggestions
- Supportive group participation
- A low-pressure karaoke atmosphere

Motivations

- Wants to bond with friends
- Wants to enjoy music socially
- Wants to participate without feeling exposed

Pain points and frustrations

- Fear of sounding awkward or off-key
- Pressure when singing alone
- Worry about being judged by others

A 4

JOBS-TO-BE-DONE

Situation	Motivation	Expected outcome
When: I go to karaoke with classmates or close friends	I want to: I want to join naturally without embarrassment	so I can: so I can feel included in the group
When: It is my turn to hold the microphone	I want to: I want to avoid sounding awkward or off-key	so I can: so I can sing without overthinking
When: Other people in the room seem more confident than me	I want to: I want a safer way to participate	so I can: so I can still enjoy karaoke without pressure
When: I am choosing songs in front of others	I want to: I want easier and safer song options	so I can: so I can feel more confident about joining in

Importance (1-10)	Satisfaction of outco...	Opportunity
9	4	9 - 4 = 5
9	3	9 - 3 = 6
8	4	8 - 4 = 4
8	5	8 - 5 = 3

A 3

USER PERSONAS



Anna

The Private Comfort Seeker

- Age ：27
- Occupation：Junior designer
- Location：Melbourne
- More info：Likes singing as a way to relax after work
- More info：Feels much more comfortable singing alone or in very small groups
- More info: Sensitive to noise, interruptions, and uncomfortable room conditions

Bio

Nora sees karaoke as something that could help her relax and reset, but only when the environment feels private and comfortable. In larger group settings, she becomes tense because of loud noise, flashing lights, social unpredictability, and the possibility of being interrupted. She prefers singing alone or with one trusted friend, where she can control the pace, the atmosphere, and the level of attention on her. For Nora, anxiety in karaoke is not only about singing ability; it is also about privacy, sensory comfort, and feeling in control of the space.

Goals | Motivations | Frustrations

Personality

Introvert	Extrovert
Analytical	Creative
Busy	Time rich
Messy	Organized
Independent	Team player
Passive	Active
Safe	Risky

Interests

- Singing alone to familiar songs
- Quiet leisure activities
- Personal playlists and relaxing routines

Influences

- Lighting, sound, and room atmosphere
- Unexpected interruptions from staff or strangers
- Whether the space feels private and secure

Goals

- Use karaoke as a comfortable and personal activity
- Sing without being watched or interrupted
- Feel safe and in control of the environment

Needs and expectations

- Better privacy and fewer interruptions
- Comfortable lighting and sound conditions
- A karaoke experience that supports solo or low-pressure participation

Motivations

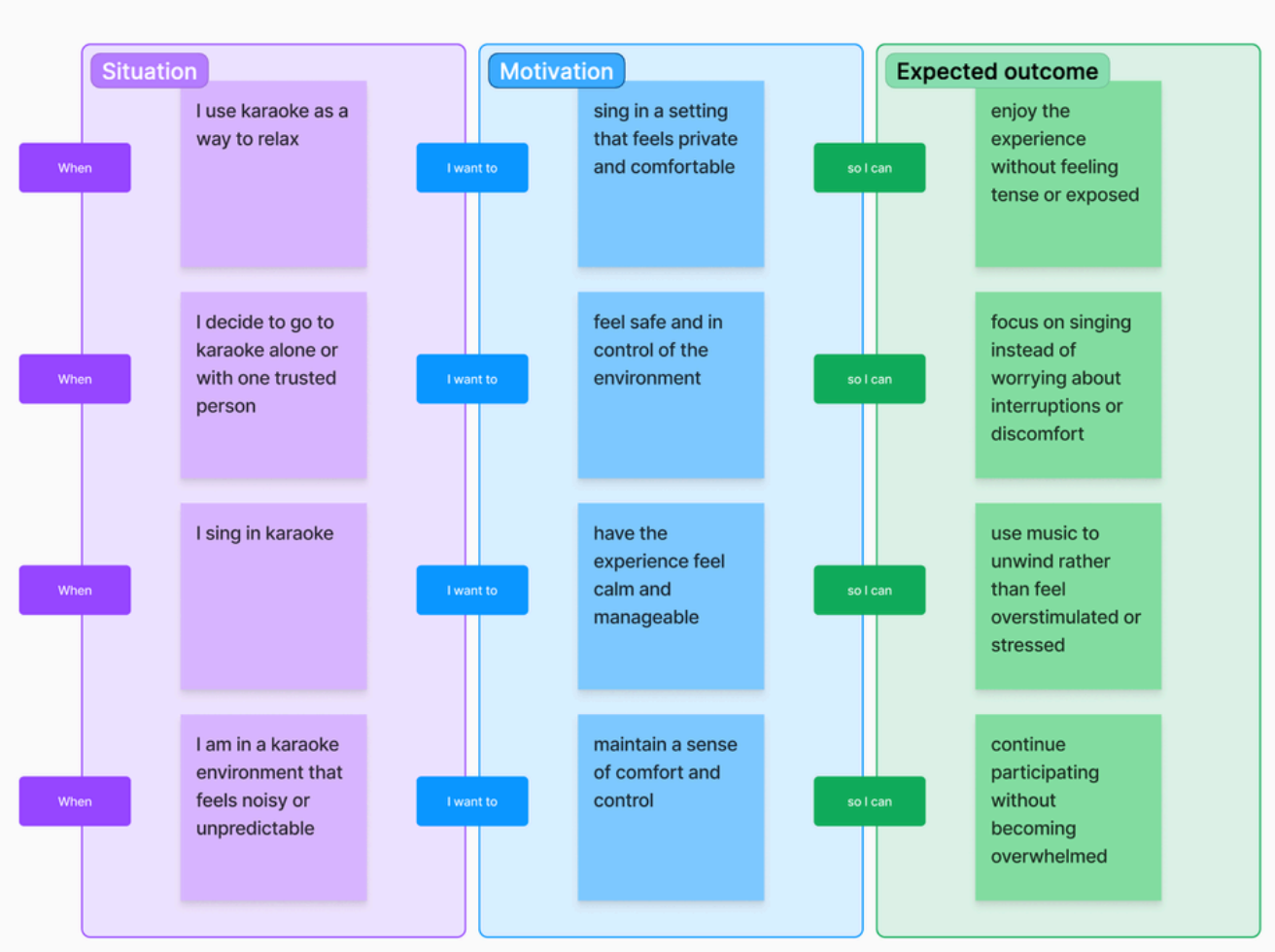
- Wants to relax through music
- Values autonomy and emotional safety
- Prefers experiences that feel calm rather than performative

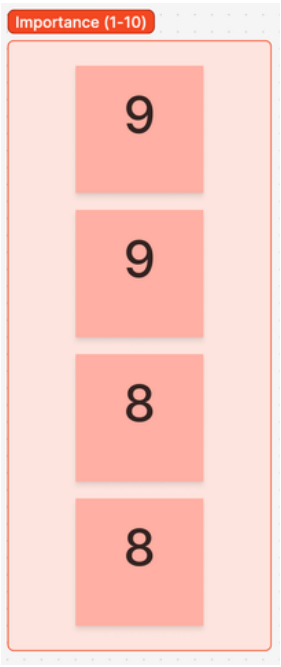
Pain points and frustrations

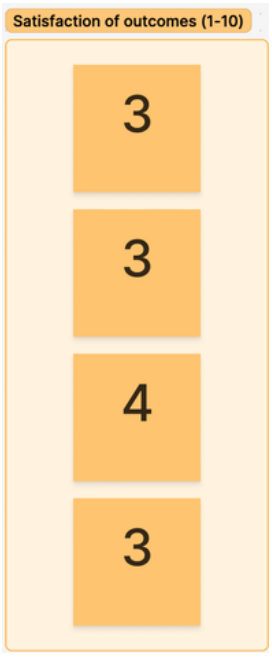
- Feels overwhelmed by noisy or overstimulating KTV spaces
- Dislikes being interrupted while singing
- Worries about safety when going alone

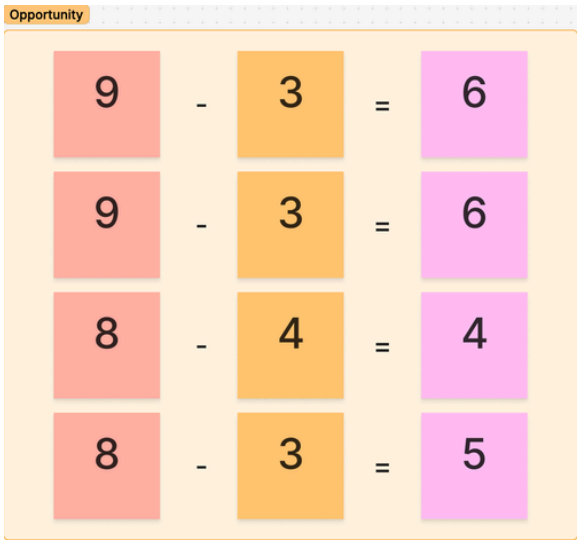
A4

JOBS-TO-BE-DONE









A 3

USER PERSONAS



John

The Overthinking Song Planner

- Age ：24
- Occupation：Graduate employee
- Location：Sydney
- More info：Usually joins karaoke after dinners, birthday gatherings, or work socials
- More info： Likes music, but becomes anxious when he has to choose songs in front of others
- More info：Often spends too much time thinking about what song is "safe" to sing

Bio

Ethan enjoys the idea of karaoke and wants to take part when friends or colleagues organise a KTV session. However, his anxiety starts before he even sings. He worries about choosing the wrong song, picking something too difficult, or making the mood awkward if the song does not fit the room. Even when he knows many songs, he often cannot remember them in the moment. He overthinks the order of songs, whether people know the song, and whether he can finish it without mistakes. As a result, he often delays his turn, chooses very familiar songs, or lets others go first.

Goals | Motivations | Frustrations

Personality

Introvert	Extrovert
Analytical	Creative
Busy	Time rich
Messy	Organized
Independent	Team player
Passive	Active
Safe	Risky

Interests

- Pop and nostalgic songs
- Group dinners and casual hangouts
- Short-form music clips and karaoke recommendations

Influences

- Group mood and audience response
- Whether other people know the song
- Previous embarrassing karaoke experiences

Goals

- Choose songs that feel safe and appropriate
- Feel prepared before it is his turn to sing
- Join karaoke without making the room awkward

Needs and expectations

- Quick access to familiar and suitable songs
- Guidance on song difficulty and audience fit
- A more supportive and less rushed song-selection process

Motivations

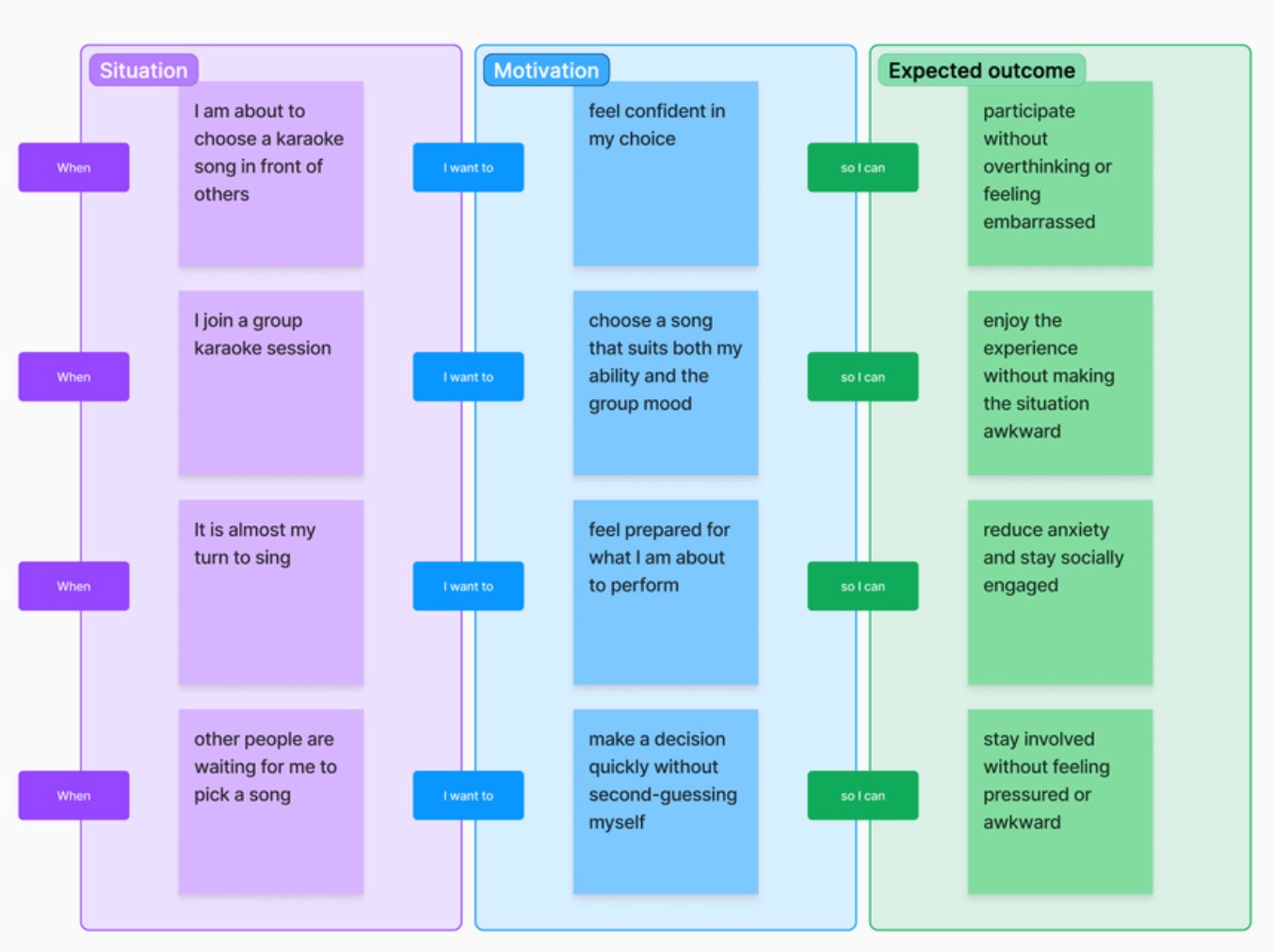
- Wants to stay included in social events
- Enjoys singing when he feels prepared
- Wants to avoid embarrassment while still participating

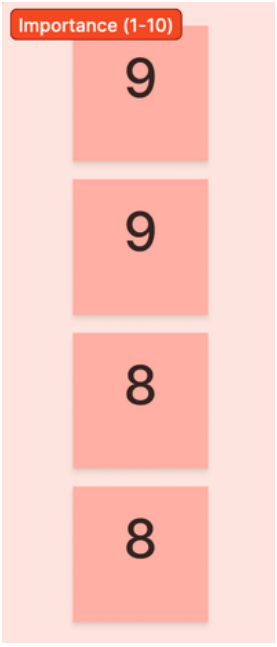
Pain points and frustrations

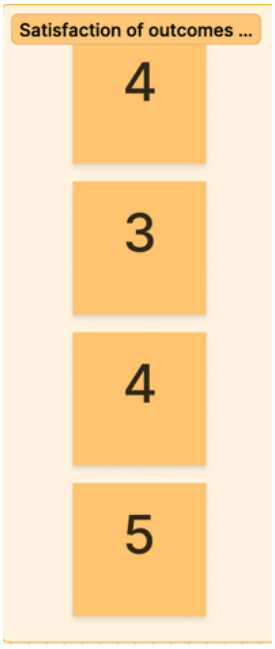
- Cannot remember songs when it is time to order
- Worries about picking songs that are too hard or too slow
- Feels pressure when others are waiting for him to decide

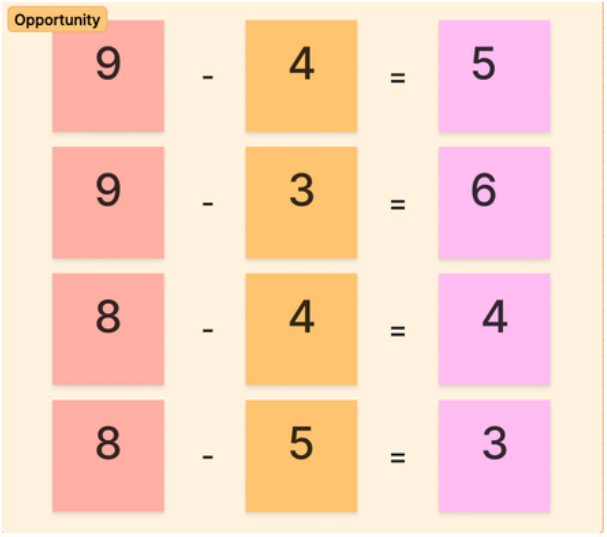
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JOBS-TO-BE-DONE









We rated each job-to-be-done statement based on importance and satisfaction to identify the strongest design opportunities.

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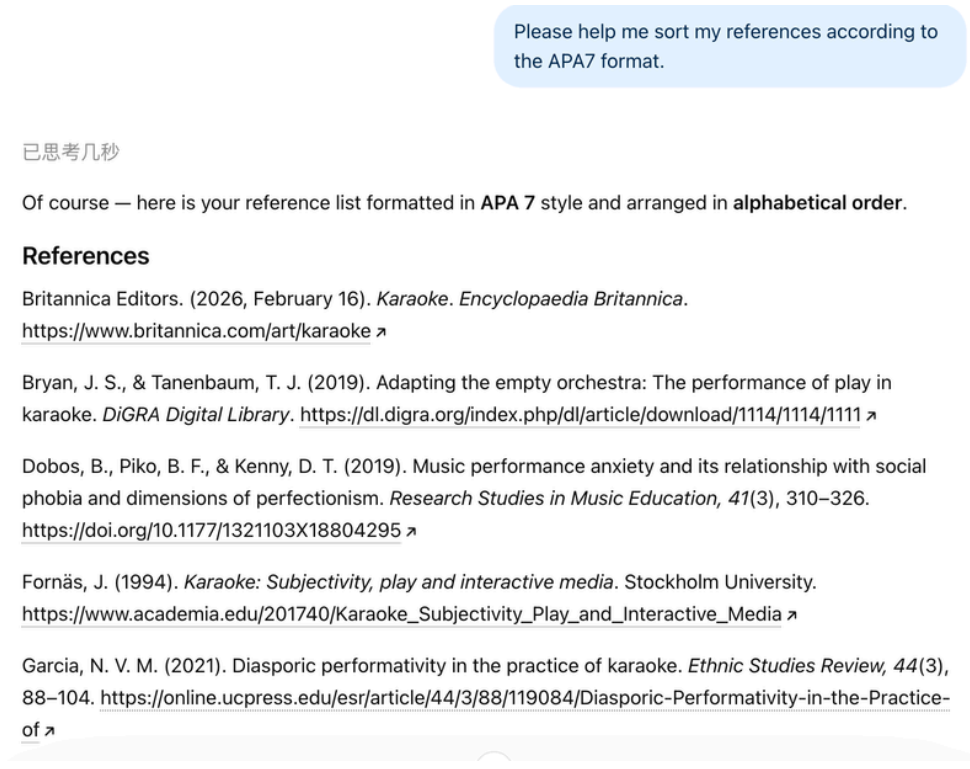
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A 5

AI ACKNOWLEDGMENT

We acknowledge the use of ChatGPT for grammar support and written expression. We also used a Canva template to support the visual presentation of this report. All core content, including the user journey stages, pain points, insights, online ethnography, personas, and jobs-to-be-done analysis, was developed by our group based on our own research. AI was not used to generate primary data.



Please help me sort my references according to the APA7 format.

已思考几秒

Of course — here is your reference list formatted in **APA 7** style and arranged in **alphabetical order**.

References

Britannica Editors. (2026, February 16). *Karaoke*. *Encyclopaedia Britannica*. https://www.britannica.com/art/karaoke

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AI ACKNOWLEDGMENT

Please help me translate this passage. 卡拉OK是一种娱乐形式，人们伴着屏幕上显示的歌词，演唱歌曲的伴奏版本。然而，卡拉OK不仅仅是一种音乐活动，它也是一种参与式的社交体验，因为它包含表演、观众的关注、轮流演唱以及群体互动。在本项目的背景下，卡拉OK尤为重要，因为它经常发生在酒吧、卡拉OK包房、派对和各种社交活动中等公共或半公共场所，用户在这些场所可能会同时体验到自信、尴尬、自我展示和群体参与等感受（《不列颠百科全书》，2026）。

Karaoke is a form of entertainment in which people sing along to instrumental versions of songs while lyrics are displayed on a screen. However, karaoke is more than just a musical activity; it is also a participatory social experience because it involves performance, audience attention, turn-taking, and group interaction. In the context of this project, karaoke is particularly significant because it often takes place in public or semi-public settings such as bars, karaoke rooms, parties, and various social events, where users may simultaneously experience confidence, embarrassment, self-presentation, and group participation (Encyclopaedia Britannica, 2026).

Please check the grammar of the text for me. The challenges facing karaoke stem not only from technical or environmental factors, but are also influenced by social and emotional factors. Research on performance anxiety suggests that people often feel anxious when performing

已思考若干秒

Here is a polished version with corrected grammar and smoother academic phrasing:

The challenges facing karaoke stem not only from technical or environmental factors, but also from social and emotional ones. Research on performance anxiety suggests that people often feel anxious when performing because of a fear of judgment, pressure to meet others' expectations, and an awareness of being watched. These dynamics are closely linked to karaoke, as participants typically perform in front of peers or an audience. Social support is also a key factor, as users who feel a lack of support are more likely to experience anxiety and may avoid participating. This suggests that the challenges associated with karaoke are deeply connected to social dynamics, emotional responses, and group interactions, rather than being merely functional issues (Huawei et al., 2024).